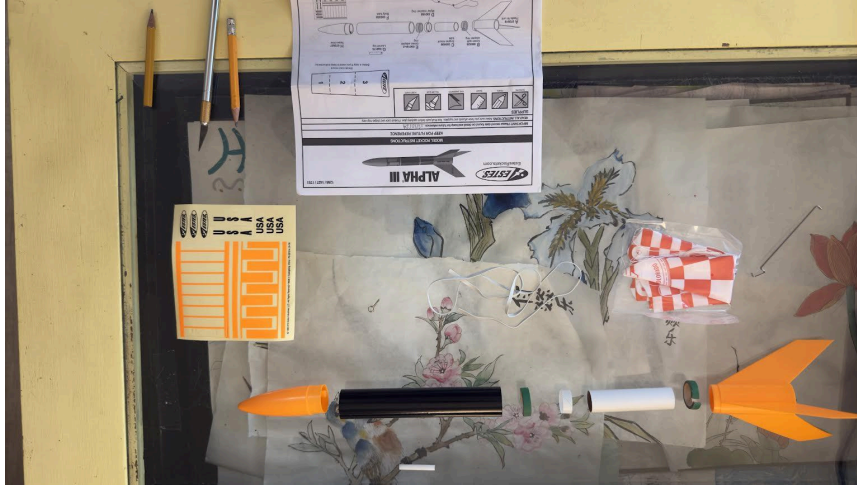


Session: Thursday, June 11th, 2026

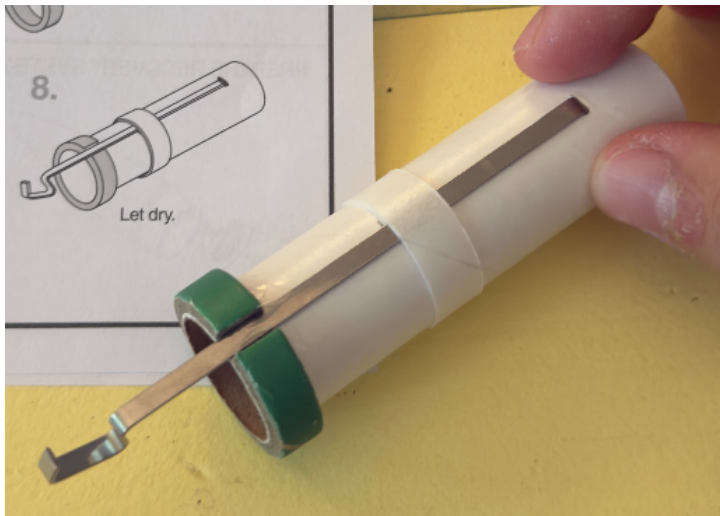
By Grace Connelly

All parts arrived as described. Assembled on a coffee table, flat glass surface.



Materials replaced: Yellow glue swapped for clear Elmer's glue. I did some research, and this is okay on the Alpha III, according to the Rocketry Forum, though sanding may be harder; I did not need to sand anything at the end of this, so that problem is negated. A big point was made to avoid school glue, which I did use briefly on the adapter ring before finding the glue-all. Fortunately, the school glue did not dry and I was able to remove the glued parts and apply the Elmer's glue-all instead.

The first part was assembled without incident.

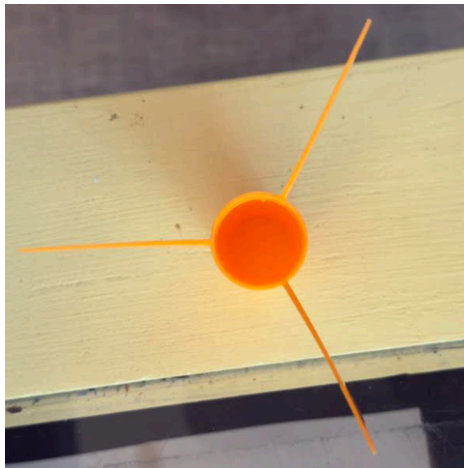


The parts fit well. I was slightly concerned that my pencil markings on the tube for where to attach the pieces weren't exactly parallel, but I double checked this with my ruler.

I noticed that the one fin on the plastic fin was bent in a way that didn't seem normal. None of the other fins had this bend, other Alpha III models did not exhibit this bend.



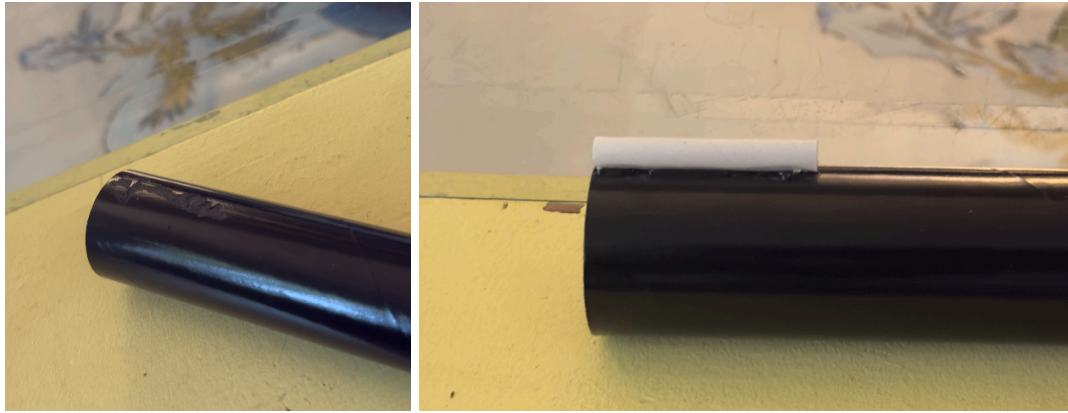
I first tried, regrettably, piling books on top of it as it hung off one edge of the table, and the severity of the bend decreased, but I couldn't ignore that it was still there, so I replaced the piece.



This one was a lot less bent, so I decided that it would do.



For the second part of the rocket, I was worried that when glued, the smaller launch lug wouldn't hold to the body tube, so I made light scratches to the surface of the tube before gluing the launch lug.



The pieces seemed to hold. I did bump the piece and the launch lug did get slightly misoriented, but I was able to correct this as the glue had not dried.



I attached both parts together, without incident.



I attached the nose cone screw to the nose cone. I screwed it in by hand as tightly as I could.

I attached the shock cord to the paper foldable used to attach it to the interior of the body tube



I had made the mistake of attaching both ends of the shock cord into the paper and then applying glue, and I was able to correct this before the glue dried, but the paper may be in poor condition.

I attached the shock cord into the body, and I attached the parachute to the nose cone via the nose cone screw, and the other end of the shock cord to the same location.



I was slightly worried that one of the two knots would come loose, but for the full duration that I was handling the rocket, they seemed to hold.



This is a slightly blurry image of the knot.

I folded the parachute and inserted it into the body. I will be provided with the recovery wadding and fuel at a later time when the rocket is due to launch. I attached the nose cone to the body, and added decals.

